

INTERROGATION RECORD: GREYFELL CITADEL AND GARETH IRONMERE

[The record is kept upon grey-stained sheets. The chamber is cold. A lamp burns low between the interrogator and the prisoner. Gareth Ironmere stands beneath restraint, his office severe, his silence more severe still.]

INTERROGATOR: State your name.

GARETH IRONMERE: Gareth Ironmere.

INTERROGATOR: Your office.

GARETH IRONMERE: Major Executioner.

INTERROGATOR: You were born in 300 AS.

[A pause. Gareth's expression does not alter. No physical feature is entered into this record; the man's presence is marked only by the discipline of his office and the concealment he carries about him.]

GARETH IRONMERE: That is written elsewhere.

INTERROGATOR: We are not speaking of elsewhere. We are speaking of Greyfell Citadel.

GARETH IRONMERE: Then speak.

INTERROGATOR: Greyfell Citadel was founded in 62 AS in the Shattered Vale. Do you deny this?

GARETH IRONMERE: I deny nothing that stone remembers.

INTERROGATOR: It is abandoned.

GARETH IRONMERE: Abandoned things are not empty.

INTERROGATOR: It lies outside the realm's core holdings.

GARETH IRONMERE: So do many graves.

[The interrogator places a sketch upon the table: a citadel of grey stone, or grey-hued ruin, set amid the broken reaches of the Shattered Vale. The walls are shown as old and desolate, their

former stronghold status reduced to abandonment.]

INTERROGATOR: This is Greyfell Citadel.

GARETH IRONMERE: That is what the sketch claims.

INTERROGATOR: Have you entered it?

GARETH IRONMERE: You ask as though entry is the matter.

INTERROGATOR: What is the matter, then?

GARETH IRONMERE: What remains after authority has gone. What listens beneath a floor. What answers when blood is offered.

[The recorder's hand halts. Gareth's demeanor remains one of grim discipline concealing forbidden devotion.]

INTERROGATOR: You secretly practice proscribed blood-rites.

GARETH IRONMERE: Secretly?

INTERROGATOR: Do not turn the word.

GARETH IRONMERE: Words are the only tools left to those who fear rites.

INTERROGATOR: Were blood-rites performed within Greyfell Citadel?

GARETH IRONMERE: Stone does not perform. Hands do.

INTERROGATOR: Yours?

[Silence. The lamp gutters. No answer is entered.]

INTERROGATOR: Did Greyfell Citadel call you?

GARETH IRONMERE: Citadels do not call. Men hear what they have already sworn to hear.

INTERROGATOR: Then you deny knowledge of the ruin?

GARETH IRONMERE: I deny the comfort of your conclusion.

[Here the interrogation is suspended. Gareth Ironmere is remanded for further questioning. The sketch of Greyfell Citadel is retained with the record.]